

Verses of Auspiciousness of the Three Jewels

Ratnatrimaṅgalagāthā · Toh 824 · Derge Kangyur

དགའོ་མཆགོ་གསུ་ག་ཤིག་ཤི་ག་ཆོག་ས་སུ་ཅད་པ།

The Verses of Auspiciousness of the Three Jewels (Sanskrit:

Ratnatrimaṅgalagāthā; Tibetan: Dkon mchog gsum gyi bkra shis kyi tshigs su bcad pa) is a short devotional text in verse, composed to invoke well-being by praising the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. Each stanza describes the qualities of one of the Three Jewels, beginning with the Tathāgata, who has crossed the ocean of saṃsāra and completed the two accumulations of merit and wisdom, and then turning to the practice of the awakening mind and the nature of reality beyond arising and ceasing. Each verse closes with the refrain asking that, through the sacred auspiciousness of that Jewel, there may be well-being here today. The text is Toh 824 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the Tantra section as one of the brief auspicious verses and homages used in recitation and ritual.

In Sanskrit: Ratna-trimaṅgala-gāthā. In Tibetan: Verses of Auspiciousness of the Three Jewels.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

The One who has triumphed over the mire of saṃsāra, as hard to cross as an ocean,
who has completed, without remainder, the two accumulations of merit and wisdom, so difficult to gather,
the Tathāgata who has become the one kin to all beings:
by that sacred auspiciousness, may there be well-being here today.

Giving up one's own aims and ever taking up the aims of others with devotion,
turning one's gaze far away from the five objects of desire,
with faith and diligence, and with the supreme companion, the awakening
mind:
by that sacred auspiciousness, may there be well-being here today.

Without arising or ceasing, having abandoned all the bonds of conceptual thought,
the supreme lamp of emptiness that destroys the darkness of ignorance,
the Dharma of accomplishing the bliss of the path, free of all manner of fixation:
by that sacred auspiciousness, may there be well-being here today.

The verses of auspiciousness of the Three Jewels.

Translator's Notes

- The opening line, "May the auspiciousness of the glorious Three Families be complete," is a scribal or colophon-style invocation preceding the title, and I have omitted it from the narrated text. The three stanzas address, in order, the Buddha, the Saṅgha, and the Dharma. The second stanza, on the bodhisattva ideal, implicitly corresponds to the Saṅgha jewel. In the second line of the second stanza, "five objects of desire" renders the five sense pleasures (Skt. pañcakāmaguṇa). The Tibetan "the practice of the path's bliss" in the third stanza is rendered "accomplishing the bliss of the path," which follows the most natural reading of the compound.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.